

# 4. PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

## 4.1 Introduction

The Project Design Phase defines how the identified requirements will be implemented in ServiceNow.

The design focuses on creating a complete incident lifecycle in which each stage of an incident is connected with the appropriate ServiceNow functionality.

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## 4.2 High-Level Solution Design

The proposed solution follows this lifecycle:

**Incident Creation**



**Incident Classification**



**Priority Determination**



**Assignment to Service Desk**



**Knowledge / Agent Assist**



**Investigation**



**Reassignment / Escalation**



## **Level 2 Investigation**



## **Resolution or Change Requirement**



## **Emergency Change Request / Related Records**



## **Incident Resolution**



## **Knowledge Article Creation**



## **SLA Validation**



## **Incident Closure**

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## **4.3 Incident Design**

The incident record should contain the information required by support teams to understand and process the issue.

Important incident information includes:

- Incident Number
- Caller / User
- Short Description
- Description
- Category
- Subcategory
- Service
- Configuration Item
- Impact
- Urgency
- Priority

- Assignment Group
  - Assigned To
  - State
  - Work Notes
  - Additional Comments
  - Resolution Information
  - Related Records
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## 4.4 Classification Design

Incident classification is designed to ensure that incidents are properly categorized and prioritized.

The classification process considers:

**Category → Subcategory → Service / CI → Impact → Urgency → Priority**

Correct classification helps the support team determine the appropriate team and resolution approach.

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## 4.5 Assignment and Escalation Design

The design provides a structured approach for assigning incidents.

The general process is:

**Service Desk → Initial Investigation → Reassignment if Required → Level 2 Support → Resolution**

If the Service Desk cannot resolve an incident, the incident can be reassigned to an appropriate Level 2 support group.

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## 4.6 Knowledge Integration Design

Knowledge Management is integrated into the incident process to allow support agents to search for existing solutions.

The design allows agents to:

- Search relevant knowledge.
  - Identify possible solutions.
  - Use existing troubleshooting information.
  - Reduce repeated investigation.
  - Reuse solutions from previous incidents.
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## 4.7 Change Management Integration Design

Some incidents require changes to the IT environment for resolution.

For such cases, the design supports the creation of an **Emergency Change Request** from the incident.

The relationship can be represented as:

**Incident → Emergency Change Request → Change Implementation → Incident Resolution**

This maintains a connection between the original incident and the change performed to resolve it.

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## 4.8 Child Incident Design

When multiple related incidents occur, child incidents can be created to track individual issues while maintaining their relationship with the parent incident.

The design provides:

**Parent Incident → Child Incident 1 / Child Incident 2 / Child Incident 3**

This improves tracking of related or recurring issues.

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## 4.9 Resolution and Knowledge Design

After an incident is investigated and resolved, the resolution information is documented.

The useful resolution information can then be used to create a Knowledge Article.

The process is:

**Incident Resolution → Document Cause and Resolution → Create Knowledge Article → Reuse Knowledge in Future Incidents**

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## 4.10 SLA Design

SLA tracking is included to monitor the time associated with incident handling.

The design provides visibility into:

- SLA status
- Time elapsed
- Time remaining
- SLA-related information
- Incident resolution progress

This helps support teams monitor incidents against defined service expectations.